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The Civilisation Research Paradigm

Across civilisational mechanics, design and transition

Overview

In 2020, The Civilization Research Institute (CRI) was founded by Daniel Schmachtenberger. Prior to this in 2017, Schmachtenberger had published a series of notes on civilisation design and transition criteria with a focus on New Economics. As a leading theorist of the metacrisis he has also spoken at length on the search for the third attractor: a civilisation design that avoids decentralised destruction by default – from multi-polar dynamics – and centralised control as counter-reaction – coercively managing catastrophic risks.

At this point in time, civilisation research – under the paradigm Schmachtenberger has pioneered – is not formally developed, even by CRI itself (at least from the outside). From a cursory investigation online, 'civilisation research', 'civilisation studies' and 'civilisation science' mostly yield results with an anthropology or complex systems emphasis – which are of course major components, but not sufficiently holistic. Similarly, whilst I have previously written on starting a new field and movement for the Metacrisis, Civilisation Alignment or Coordination (Studies), Civilisation Research subsumes these as the highest-level or most foundational frame possible.

My goal with this document is to give a conceptual structure to the paradigm of Civilisation Research and set out a preliminary research agenda: to be undertaken outside of and beyond CRI – across a wider (generative cooperative) research network. Essentially this document serves an onboarding function (assembling everything in one place) for those who are new to this extremely large-scale and complex domain of thought.

Structure

In my conceptual model of civilisation research, it is subdivided into nine subframes: three civilisational–, three meta– and three macro–. These latter clusters inform and are conceptually subordinate to the Civilisational framework. I set out each of these in the sections below.

Contents

- Civilisational
  - Civilisational Mechanics
  - Civilisation Design
  - Civilisational Transition
- Meta
  - Metacrisis
  - Metamodernism
  - Metatheory
- Macro
  - Macrohistory
  - Macrosociology
  - Macrostrategy

Civilisational

Civilisational Mechanics

Civilisation Design

Civilisational Transition

Meta

Metacrisis

Metamodernism

Metatheory

Macro

Macrohistory

Macrosociology

Macrostrategy